Christian Vedel

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Research Interests

- What drives all of my research is a simple premise: much of what we know about the economic cosmos is limited by what we can measure. I build machine learning tools and large-scale historical datasets to recover economic measurements from the past, and combine them with causal inference methods to study how geography and institutions shape prosperity. The ultimate aim is to use the vastness of history to give policy makers better maps of what can be changed, what cannot, and where the limits of policy lie. **Keywords:** Economic history, economic development, causal inference, machine learning, economic geography, large-scale historical data.

Experience

University of Southern Denmark, Assistant Professor — Odense, Denmark
Fixed-term, non-tenure-track appointment. Department of Economics, Historical Economics and Development Group (HEDG). — Jan 2023 – Jan 2027, 4 years 1 month

University of Copenhagen, External Lecturer — Jan 2024 – present, 2 years 10 months
Summer School in European Economic History, Department of Economics.

University of Southern Denmark, Student Research Assistant — Jan 2018 – Jan 2019, 1 year 1 month
Department of Economics.

University of Southern Denmark, Teaching Assistant — Jan 2017 – Jan 2017, 1 month
Department of Economics.

Education

PhD — **University of Southern Denmark**, Economics — Jan 2020 – Jan 2023
- Thesis: Natural Experiments in Geography and Institutions — Essays in the Economic History of Denmark
- Main advisor: Paul Sharp
- Co-advisors: Christian Møller Dahl, Casper Worm Hansen

London School of Economics, Economic History — Jan 2022 – Jan 2022
- Visiting Research Student (Jan 17 – May 31, 2022)
- Host: Prof. Max Schulze

BSc and MSc — **University of Southern Denmark**, Economics — Jan 2015 – Jan 2021

Nyborg Gymnasium, International Baccalaureate Diploma Programme (IBDP) — Jan 2010 – Jan 2013

Publications

Holy cows and spilled milk: The impact of religious missions on firm-level productivity — Jan 2026
Bentzen, J. S., Boberg-Fazlić, N., Sharp, P., Skovsgaard, C. V., Vedel, C.
doi.org/10.1016/j.jdeveco.2025.103651 (Journal of Development Economics, 179, 103651)

Ireland in a Danish mirror: A microlevel comparison of the productivity of Danish and Irish creameries before the First World War — Jan 2026
McLaughlin, E., Sharp, P., Tsoukli, X., Vedel, C.
doi.org/10.1080/00076791.2025.2486643 (Business History, 68(3), 596–612)

Adaptability, diversification, and energy shocks: A firm level productivity analysis Jan 2024
Henriques, S. T., Sharp, P., Tsoukli, X., Vedel, C.
doi.org/10.1016/j.eneco.2024.107887 (Energy Economics, 139, 107887)

A Microlevel Analysis of Danish Dairy Cooperatives: Opportunities for Large Data in Business History Jan 2024
Sharp, P., Henriques, S., McLaughlin, E., Tsoukli, X., Vedel, C.
doi.org/10.1017/eso.2023.5 (Enterprise & Society, 25(3), 669–697)

A Firm Level Database of Irish Creameries, 1897–1921 Jan 2024
McLaughlin, E., Sharp, P., Tsoukli, X., Vedel, C.
doi.org/10.1177/03324893231161927 (Irish Economic and Social History, 51(1), 48–74)

Working Papers

- Vedel, C. (2024; latest version 2026). **A Perfect Storm: First-Nature Geography and Economic Development.** EHES Working Paper 262. Under review, *Journal of the European Economic Association*. arxiv.org/abs/2408.00885. *Winner of the Economic History Society's 2023 New Researcher Prize.* **(Job Market Paper)**
- Johansen, T., Koschnick, J., & Vedel, C. (2026). **How to deal with machine learning bias in economic history.** arxiv.org/abs/2606.28063.
- Dahl, C. M., Johansen, T., & Vedel, C. (2024; latest version 2026). **Breaking the HISCO Barrier: Automatic Occupational Standardization with OccCANINE.** EHES Working Paper 255. Revise and resubmit, *Explorations in Economic History*. arxiv.org/abs/2402.13604.
- Görges, T., Rove, M. Ø., Sharp, P., & Vedel, C. (2025; latest version 2026). **Tracks to Modernity: Railroads, Growth, and Social Movements in Denmark.** Revise and resubmit, *European Review of Economic History*. arxiv.org/abs/2502.21141.
- Aaskoven, L., & Vedel, C. (2026). **Physical Memories of the Past and Support for the Far-Right: Evidence from Inter-War Denmark.** EHES Working Paper 295. ehes.org/wp/EHES_295.pdf.
- McLaughlin, E., Sharp, P., Skovsgaard, C. V., & Vedel, C. (2024). **Milk Wars: Cooperation, Contestation, Conflict and the Irish War of Independence.** EHES Working Paper 272. ehes.org/wp/EHES_272.pdf.
- Bentzen, J. S., Boberg-Fazlić, N., Sharp, P., Skovsgaard, C. V., & Vedel, C. (2024). **Assimilate for God: The Impact of Religious Divisions on Danish American Communities.** EHES Working Paper 253. ehes.org/wp/EHES_253.pdf.

Other Publications

- Vedel, C. (2023). *Natural Experiments in Geography and Institutions: Essays in the Economic History of Denmark.* [Ph.D. thesis, University of Southern Denmark]. doi.org/10.21996/jt34-zc23.
- Vedel, C. (2025). Review of *Danish Capitalism in the 20th Century: A Business History of an Innovistic Mixed Economy*, by Stefan Kirkegaard Sløk-Madsen. *Scandinavian Economic History Review*, 73(2), 160–162.
- Vedel, C. (2022). Trap Denmark: Tønder, Aabenraa, Sønderborg (vol. 17). *Scandinavian Economic History Review*. doi.org/10.1080/03585522.2021.2013315.
- Vedel, C. (2022). A very natural experiment: using nature to measure how infrastructure produces growth. *LSE Economic History Blog.* blogs.lse.ac.uk/economichistory.

Funding & Prizes

- **2027–2030 — Danish Independent Research Fund (DFF-Forskningsprojekt2): 6,114,741 DKK.** *Denmark's Path to Economic Development: Structural Transformation, Free-Market Trade, and Migration from 1790 to Today.* PI: Casper Worm Hansen. Named project participant.
- **2023 — EHS Best New Researcher Prize.** Awarded at the Economic History Society's Annual Conference.
- **2022 — Augustinusfonden: 15,000 DKK (€2,016).** Towards research stay at the London School of Economics.

Teaching

- *S = Spring semester, F = Fall semester.*
- **2026S — Statistics.** Course coordinator and lecturer. Introductory statistics for undergraduate Economics students. Open-source material: github.com/christianvedels/Introductory_statistics.
- **2024–2026 — The Economic History of Europe.** Summer school, University of Copenhagen.
- **2024–2026 — Historical Perspectives on Current Economics Issues: Big Data and Applications.** HEDG PhD Summer School. Two-lecture module on machine learning for economic history, taught with Torben Johansen. Slides: github.com/TorbenSDJohansen/hedg-summer-school.
- **2023F–2025F — News and Market Sentiment Analysis.** Lecturer. Natural language processing for the Data Science Master's programme. Open-source material: github.com/christianvedels/News_and_Market_Sentiment_Analytics.
- **2025S — Statistics.** Lecturer. Introductory statistics for undergraduate Business Administration and European Studies students.
- **2023F–2024S — Microeconomics.** Lecturer. Introductory microeconomics for business students.
- **2022F — Business History.** Lecturer with Elena Korchmina.
- **2020–2022 — Tietgen talent track.** Coordinated the programme and taught everything from basic economic theory to the latest research and basic statistics for high-school students.
- **2020F — Introduction to Business and Economic History (undergraduate).** Teaching assistant (partly online due to COVID).
- **2020–2021 — Regression Analysis (undergraduate).** Guest lecturer for one week in both years; taught an introduction to the R programming language.
- **2020S — Econometrics II (undergraduate).** Teaching assistant (partly online due to COVID).
- **2017F — Macroeconomics (undergraduate).** Teaching assistant.

Supervision

- **PhD students:** Co-supervisor of Maret Anne Grapengeter (2024–2027, University of Oslo).
- **Master thesis (Economics), 2025:** Lea Lundberg Yssing, Sharmin Ather Keya.
- **Master thesis (Mathematical Economics), 2026:** Katrine Enghoff Olsen, Lajza Prekazi.
- **Master thesis (Data Science):** Frederikke Buchsti Hermansen, Christoffer Johan Meilby Nobel, Rune Dissing Bjerring (2026); Lukas Rask Svendsen (2025).

Presentations

- **2026:** Social Science History Association (Atlanta); Danish Society for Economic and Social History (SDU); Computational Economic History workshop (CSH Vienna); Big Data and Machine Learning in Economic History (Uppsala); Economic History Society Centenary Conference (London); CEPR Workshop (Copenhagen); Public Lecture, Society of Transport Economics (Copenhagen).
- **2025:** Social Science History Association (Chicago); Applied Economic Seminar Series (UCPH); LEAP Workshop on Economic History in the Age of AI (Stellenbosch); Swedish Economic History Meeting / SSEHS Conference (Umeå); ENCHOS (Cracow); European Society of Historical Demography Conference (Bologna).
- **2024:** 2nd Norwegian Winter Games (Oslo); Machine Learning workshop, Dept. of Economic History (Lund); 13th Annual Growth Workshop, HEDG (Odense); Economic History Society Annual Conference (Newcastle); 3rd Danish Historical Political Economy Workshop (Odense); CITP Conference (Nottingham); Advanced Methods Workshop (Lyon); Danish Econometrics Society (Sandbjerg).
- **2023:** Seminar, Dept. of Economic History (Lund); 12th Annual Growth Workshop, HEDG (Odense); Economic History Society Annual Conference (Warwick); PhD seminar (Odense); End-of-semester workshop (Copenhagen); 9th World Cliometrics Conference; 4th SSEHS Conference (Lund); ENCHOS Conference (Linz); 9th Danish Society of Economic and Social History (Copenhagen).
- **2022:** XIX World Economic History Congress (Paris); EHES Conference (Groningen); LSE Graduate Economic History Seminar (London); 11th Annual Growth Workshop, HEDG (Odense); 3rd Scandinavian Meeting for Economic and Social History (Odense); HEDG Miniworkshop for Young Scholars (Odense).
- **2020–2021:** Agricliometrics IV (UC3M Madrid); HEDG Miniworkshop for Young Scholars; DGPE Annual Meeting; PhD seminars, Dept. of Economics (SDU, Odense).

Academic Service

- **Refereeing:** *Review of Economics and Statistics Scandinavian Economic History Review Demographic Research Digital Scholarship in the Humanities Historical Methods* Programme Committee of the International Conference on Natural Language and Speech Processing (ICNLSP).
- **Community:** Editor, EHES Working Paper Series (European Historical Economics Society); Board member, Danish Society for Economic and Social History.
- **Organisation:** Co-organiser, Annual Workshop on Growth, History and Development (HEDG); co-organiser of the Policy Event (2025, 2026).

Non-academic Employment

- **2019–2020 — Number Crunch, Odense.** My own small data consulting firm.
- **2018–2019 — Municipality of Copenhagen.** Student assistant, data and analysis, health and care administration.

Languages

Danish
Fluent (native)

English
Fluent

Norwegian
Basic

Swedish
Basic